My visits, incidentally, gave me a new insight on the state bureaucracy. One black man told me he had been trying to help young men from welfare families in his community to find work, and he had taken a half dozen or so to a state employment assistance office to register for jobs.

After they finished and were standing outside the state office, he said he questioned the young men about their applications and learned that two or three of them had not answered a few of the questions on the application forms; so he took them back inside so that they could fill in the blanks.

When they returned to the office, the clerks said they couldn't find the applications.

Since they'd only been gone a few minutes, the man walked over to a wastebasket on a hunch and discovered all of the young men's job applications had been tossed away. When I got back to Sacramento, I made sure that our bureaucrats didn't do that again.

At a meeting in East Los Angeles, several mothers told me that their kids weren't doing well in school, in part because their teachers were ignoring the fact that their native language was Spanish.

One mother told me that because her son had had difficulty in school, his teacher had sent him to a special class for retarded children; luckily, another teacher realized his only problem was difficulty with English, and he was transferred out of the class and eventually graduated from high school with the highest honors. This mother told me she knew of other children who had not been as fortunate as her son. I suggested to the group of mothers that they volunteer to take turns visiting their children's classes to monitor whether their children were having a language problem. They looked at each other, then back at me, and said they'd be delighted to do that, but couldn't because